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Mahavir Mandir

Mahavir Mandir is a Hindu temple dedicated to the god Hanuman, located in Patna, Bihar, India. Millions of pilgrims visit the temple every year.[1][2] Acharya Kishore Kunal is the secretary of the Mahavir Mandir Temple Trust, Patna.[3] After the Vaishno Devi Temple, this temple has the highest earnings of over 1 lakh per day rendering its trust budgets as the second highest in the northern part of the country. The temple attracts huge crowds on festivals like Ramnavami. It is one of the leading temples dedicated to the worship of Lord Hanuman.

Mahavir Mandir	
Hanuman Mandir	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
Deity	Hanuman
Festivals	Rama Navami, Hanuman Jayanti
Location	
Location	Patna
State	Bihar
Country	India
Location in Patna	
Coordinates	25°36′14″N 85°8′11″E
Architecture	
Type	Nagara Architecture
Completed	First built – unknown Rebuilt – 1947 Final Rebuilt – 1987
Elevation	57 m (187 ft)
Website	
mahavirmandirpatna.org (https://mahavirmandirpatna.org)	

History

As per the Patna High Court judgment in 1948, the temple has existed since time immemorial.[4] But due to the scrutiny of historical facts and traditions, it appears that this temple was originally established by swami Balanand, an ascetic of the Ramanandi sect in around 1730 CE. This temple gained popularity in 1947 with a large number of Hindu refugees coming to Patna after the partition of India. Subsequently, the temple was rebuilt as a concrete house, which was demolished in 1987 to construct a huge marble temple. The idol of Sankat-Mochan, an avatar of Hanuman, stands in it.[5]

Visits

Long winding queues can be seen at the temple on Saturdays and Tuesdays, the traditional worshiping days of Hanuman. Thousands of people visit Mahavir Mandir every Rama Navami and New Year celebration.[6] On Rama Navami, the queues can be over one kilometer long.[7][8]

Dalit Priest

Since 13 June 1993, Suryavanshi Das, a person from the Dalit caste, has been priest of the temple, the decision received support from three well known priests—Ramchandra Paramahans, Mahant Avaidyanath of Baba Gorakhnath Dham and Mahant Avadh Kishore Das.[9]

Ram Rasoi

Arrangements for free food have been made to the devotees who visit Ramlala at Ram Rasoi.[10] Acharya Kishore Kunal, secretary of the Shri Mahavir Sthan Nyas Samiti,[11] started it on Sunday 1 December 2019. This free food facility functions in the Amava temple just outside the temple of Ramlala, at Amawa Mandir Complex, Ramkot, Ayodhya-224123.[12] Devotees who visit Ramlala at Ram Rasoi get free food between 11:30 am till 3:00 pm every day.
For this, 60 quintals of Govind Bhog shear rice have been sent to Ayodhya.[13] This rice has been sourced from Mokri village in Kaimur (Bihar).[14] The services of Shri Ram's kitchen and Shri Ramlala's bhog will function continuously. There is arrangement of feeding one thousand people daily in the initial phase. After this, based on the increasing number of Ramlala's devotees, food will be arranged for more and more people.

Philanthropic work by Shri Mahavir Sthan Nyas Samiti

Mahavir Mandir Trust is named *Shri Mahavir Sthan Nyas Samiti*(*श्री महावीर स्थान न्यास समिति*).[11] Headed by Acharya Kishore Kunal, the trust monitors working and development of temple. The Trusts uses the temple fund to run human welfare organizations and hospitals like Mahavir Cancer Institute & Research Centre,[15][16] Mahavir Vaatsalya Hospital and Mahavir Arogya Hospital and other several hospitals and orphanage in the agricultural and rural state of Bihar. The Mahavir Mandir Trust has the second highest budget in North India, after that of the Maa Vaishno Devi shrine.[17]

Publications

The temple started the publication of *Dharmayan*, a magazine focusing on culture, religion, and nationality in 1990. Since then the magazine has continuously been in publication. They recently celebrated a Diamond Jublee with the publication of its 100th issue. Dignitaries such as Acharya Sitaram Chaturvedi, Sahitya Vachaspati Shriranjan Suridev, Dr. Kashinath Mishra have been associated with this esteemed magazine. Currently Acharya Kishore Kunal graces the position of Chief Editor and it is being edited by Pandit Bhavanath Jha.

See also

- Viraat Ramayan Mandir
- Deo Sun Temple

- Baba Garib Sthan Mandir

References

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External links

- Mahavir Mandir published an ebook on Ayodhya debate written by Acharya Kishore Kunal that was at this link www.mahavirmandirpatna.org/prakashan/ebook/bookindex.html (https://www.mahavirmandirpatna.org/prakashan/ebook/bookindex.html)
- Mahavir Mandir Patna official website (https://www.mahavirmandirpatna.org)
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